SEPA RESOURCE LIBRARY

SEPA DAT ONBOARDING

DAT Member Expectations

What you commit to, what we commit to, and what you get

Updated **October 12, 2026**

The American Red Cross Disaster Action Team (DAT) responds to local disasters for residents displaced from their homes. Being a DAT member is uniquely rewarding: our Responders meet clients face to face to offer compassion, meet immediate needs for shelter, and connect them with recovery services.

Disasters happen unexpectedly. So that families don't face tough times alone, our members respond 24/7, 365 days a year, and commit to train and exercise to deliver service consistent with the principles and values of the American Red Cross.

DAT Responders commit to

- Meet initial training requirements within 90 days
- Stay current with response procedures, new training and system updates
- Attend in-person training within our 5-county region
- Be Generally Available for shifts
- Sign up for On Call shifts (strongly encouraged: On Call Responders are considered first)
- Be ready to leave for a response within 15 minutes when On Call
- Respond in person throughout your county, and consider nearby counties
- Follow the ARC Service Delivery Plan and safety procedures
- Use your own smartphone to respond, and a tablet or laptop to open cases
- Get yourself to scenes by personal vehicle, public transportation or, in some cases, an ARC vehicle (training required)
- Attend monthly regional DAT and Disaster Cycle Services meetings
- Record volunteer hours (training, responses, etc.) in your profile

DAT Leadership commits to

- Onboard and orient new members, and respond promptly to inquiries
- Support members with curriculum-based training and integrated exercises
- Mentor on scene (and virtually) for consistent client care
- Support customized and repeating shift sign-ups
- Follow Red Cross standards and procedures to ensure safety
- Guide Responders who want to take on leadership roles
- Share related ARC opportunities that support the DAT mission

Benefits include

- Deeply rewarding experiences supporting your community
- Personal growth, leadership positions and national deployments
- Meeting teammates from diverse backgrounds
- Being part of a team and the Red Cross family!

Thank you for committing!

Questions about any of these? Ask your Team Leader.